Our account focuses on what we identify as the most prevalent and impactful tactics in the populist playbook. While not exhaustive, these strategies illustrate the breadth and depth of populist opposition to IOs. From calculated noncompliance to the strategic withholding of resources, populist leaders employ a range of approaches that challenge IOs' ability to govern effectively. These strategies are summarized in table 2.1.

However, this chapter is not solely about populists' actions; we also connect these tactics to the broader consequences they have for the international system. Chapter 3 builds on this foundation by presenting empirical tests that support the patterns and mechanisms outlined here. Yet our primary focus remains on IOs' responses to these attacks—how they can adapt, counter, and ultimately endure. By examining the interplay between populist subversion and IO resilience, we aim to illuminate the lasting impact of populism on global governance.

TABLE 2.1. Populist tactics to undermine IOs

Tactic	Examples
Exit	• US withdrawal from the Paris Agreement during Trump's first presidency. • Brexit and its potential domino effect on the EU. • Greece's near-departure from the Eurozone during the Eurocrisis.
Creating competitor IOs	• Establishment of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) as an alternative to the World Bank. • Creation of regional organizations like the Visegrád Group (V4) and the Bolivarian Alliance for the Peoples of Our America (ALBA). • Use of rival IOs for symbolic politics, as seen with UNASUR.
Cutting funds	• Trump withholding funding from NATO, WHO, UNHCR, and UNESCO.